

## 008. Chapter 2 Verse 20-22

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

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### VERSE 2.20

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न जायते म्रियते वा कदाचि  
नायं भूत्वा भविता वा न भूयः ।  
अजो नित्यः शाश्वतोऽयं पुराणो  
न हन्यते हन्यमाने शरीरे ॥ 20 ॥

na jāyate mriyate vā kadācin-  
nāyaṃ bhūtvā bhavitā vā na bhūyaḥ |  
ajo nityaḥ śāśvato'yaṃ purāṇo  
na hanyate hanyamāne śarīre ||

◆ **na** - never; **jāyate** - is born; **mriyate** - dies; **vā** - or; **kadācit** - at any time; ◆ **na** - not; **ayaṃ** - this; **bhūtvā** - having been; **bhavitā** - will be; **vā** - or; **na** - not; **bhūyaḥ** - again; ◆ **ajaḥ** - unborn; **nityaḥ** - eternal; **śāśvataḥ** - changeless; **ayaṃ** - this; **purāṇaḥ** - ancient; ◆ **na** - not; **hanyate** - is killed; **hanyamāne** - being killed; **śarīre** - in the body.

**Atma is not born, nor does it ever die; after having been it does not cease to be, unborn, eternal, changeless and ancient, it is not killed when the body is destroyed.**

## VERSE 2.21

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DEVAGIAवेदाविनाशिनं नित्यं य एनमजमव्ययम् ।  
कथं स पुरुषः पार्थ कं घातयति हन्ति कम् ॥ 21 ॥

vedāvināśinaṃ nityaṃ  
ya enamajamavyayam |  
kathaṃ sa puruṣaḥ pārtha  
kaṃ ghātayati hanti kam ||

◆ **veda** - knows; **avināśinaṃ** - indestructible; **nityaṃ** - eternal; ◆ **yaḥ** - who; **enam** - this; **ajam** - unborn; **avyayam** - immutable; ◆ **kathaṃ** - how; **saḥ** - that; **puruṣaḥ** - person; **pārtha** - O Partha (Arjuna); ◆ **kaṃ** - whom; **ghātayati** - causes to be killed; **hanti** - kills; **kaṃ** - whom.

**O Arjuna! He who knows that Atma is birthless, deathless, real, and imperishable, whom can he slay or cause to be slain?**

## VERSE 2.22

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वासांसि जीर्णानि यथा विहाय  
नवानि गृह्णाति नरोऽपराणि ।  
तथा शरीराणि विहाय जीर्णा  
न्यन्यानि संयाति नवानि देही ॥ 22 ॥

vāsāṃsi jīrṇāni yathā vihāya  
navāni grhṇāti naro'parāṇi |  
tathā śarīrāṇi vihāya jīrṇāny  
anyāni saṃyāti navāni dehī ||

◆ vāsāṃsi - clothes; jīrṇāni - worn out; yathā - as; vihāya - casting off; ◆  
navāni - new; grhṇāti - takes on; narah - a man; aparāṇi - others; ◆ tathā - so;  
śarīrāṇi - bodies; vihāya - casting off; jīrṇāni - worn out; ◆ anyāni - others;  
saṃyāti - enters; navāni - new; dehī - the embodied Soul.

**Just as a man casts off his worn-out clothes and puts on new ones so also the Self throws away its worn-out bodies and takes other fresh bodies.**